Patel, Ajaz NZL

New Zealand M · Left Orthodox · **vs left-handers**

BALLS	WICKETS	ECONOMY	BOWLING AVG
1,406	28	4.1	34.3

STRIKE RATE	AVG SPEED	AVG LENGTH	ROUND THE WKT
50.2	85.1 kph P99 98.9	4.21 m Short 0%	11% LHB 11% · RHB 92%

Scouting Summary

COMMON THEMES

- Left Orthodox, averaging 85.1 kph (up to 98.9).
- Typical length is **4-5m** (their good length); median 4.2 m.
- Stock ball is **full wide outside off, turning in, drifting away, passing outside off** (41% of deliveries).
- Goes round the wicket 11% of the time against left-handers.
- Turns it 4.8° on average; 45% of balls turn ≥5°.

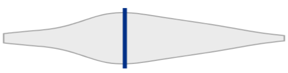
BIGGEST THREATS

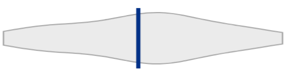
- Most dangerous length is **Good Length** (8 wkts, 2.5% adjusted strike).
- Danger pitching line: **4th stump**.
- Takes 60% of wickets pitching **full wide outside off**, over the wicket.
- Beats the bat 6.0% of tracked balls (false-shot 13.1%).
- Most likely to dismiss you **caught** (43% of wickets).
- 25% of catches are behind the wicket (keeper / slips / gully); most often to square leg: short leg, fine leg: leg slip, long on: regulation.
- Very repeatable with his length — using your feet to change his length is more effective than waiting for a loose ball.

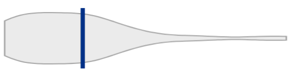
AREAS TO EXPLOIT

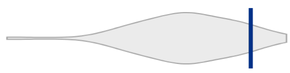
- Concedes most runs pitching **full wide outside off** (39% of runs).
- Away from good length, the wicket threat drops off — look to score in the less-productive lengths.
- Most of his runs leak through the leg side (37%) — his main scoring release.
- Cash in when he goes **good length wide outside off** (economy 5.5, beats the bat only 14%).

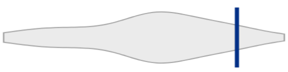
Bowling Fingerprint

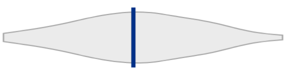
Release height
P47

2.06 m · vs left-arm spin

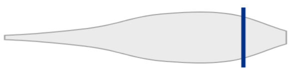
Crease width
P44

81 cm · vs left-arm spin

Crease variation
P60

±17 cm · vs left-arm spin

Turn
P89

4.7° · vs spin bowlers

Drift
P90

2.2° · vs spin bowlers

Bounce
P47

4.3° · vs spin bowlers

Repeatability
P83

±0.9 m · vs spin bowlers

*Percentile within same-type peers (grey = the peer distribution, line = this bowler). Release/crease vs hand × pace/spin; movement/speed/repeatability vs pace/spin. Release & speed are modern-era (2017+ / partial). **Crease variation** = how much he moves his release point sideways across the crease from ball to ball (within his main angle): a high percentile = he varies where he lets the ball go a lot, a low percentile = he releases from the same spot every ball. **Repeatability** = length consistency over his stock-length band (2–11 m, so deliberate yorkers and bouncers don't count as poor control): a high percentile = tighter, more metronomic lengths than peers; a low percentile = he varies his length more. A marker at the very edge = he sits beyond the typical peer range on that trait.*

Current Form (last 5 Tests · 2024-09-26 → 2025-12-18)

He's around his career level lately (avg 30 last 5 vs 29 career).

Window	Balls	Wkts	Avg	Econ	SR	False%	Avg speed	Avg length
Last 5 Tests	1,147	21	29.9	3.28	54.6	21%	84	4.45 m
Career	5,020	91	28.8	3.13	55.2	13%	84	4.40 m

Threat Profile ▶ watch wickets

BEATEN %
6.0%
n=1,406

FALSE-SHOT %
13.1%
beaten + edges

AVG TURN
4.8°
45% ≥5°

AVG DRIFT
2.0°
in-air

How he gets you out	His %	Base	Index
Caught	43%	59%	0.73×
Bowled	25%	17%	**1.48×**
LBW	18%	20%	**0.90×**
Stumped	14%	4%	**3.22×**

*Share of his 28 wickets by type, indexed against the base rate vs the average spin bowler to LHB (men's Tests). **Index >1** = he does it more than most, **<1** = less. Caught is high for everyone — the signal is the over-indexed row.*

Catches to: Square leg: short leg 4 · Fine leg: leg slip 2 · Long on: regulation 2 · Point: regulation 1 · Mid on: regulation 1 · Keeper 1

Angle & variations: Round the wicket to RHB (92%), stays over to LHB

Stock Ball & Ball Types (vs left-handers) ▶ watch stock balls

Stock ball — full wide outside off, turning in, drifting away, passing outside off (41% of deliveries, economy 4.42). Minor variations: full outside off (22%) and a good length wide outside off (15%).

Ball type (pitch length × pitching line)	Movement	%	Econ	Wkts	Beaten %
full wide outside off ▶	turning in, drifting away	41%	4.42	15	17%
full outside off ▶	turning in, drifting away	22%	3.88	0	10%
a good length wide outside off ▶	turning in, drifting away	15%	5.52	3	14%
a good length outside off ▶	turning in, drifting away	7%	3.54	3	11%
full in the channel ▶	turning in, drifting away	5%	3.05	2	14%
full on the stumps ▶	turning in, drifting away	4%	3.00	0	9%

*Ball type = pitch-length band × pitching-line region. **Movement** = swing in the air + seam/turn off the pitch, whichever is material, dominant first (ball-tracking, tracked balls only; blank if too few). **Beaten %** = false-shot rate on tracked balls. The stock-ball line above also notes where it passes the stumps.*

New ball vs old ball

New ball (≤30 ov) · 635 balls · 15 wkts · econ 4.18

Top ball type	%	Econ	Wkts
full wide outside off	39%	4.24	5
full outside off	22%	3.78	0
a good length wide outside off	19%	5.77	3
a good length outside off	7%	3.43	3

*Most lethal: **good length Wide of 6th** (2.6 wkts/100).*

Old ball (31+ ov) · 771 balls · 13 wkts · econ 4.03

Top ball type	%	Econ	Wkts
full wide outside off	42%	4.57	10
full outside off	22%	3.97	0
a good length wide outside off	12%	5.14	0
full in the channel	7%	2.00	2

*Most lethal: **full Wide of 6th** (3.6 wkts/100).*

How his ball types and threat shift with ball age (split at 30 overs). Empty side = too few balls in that phase.

Danger Zones (vs left-handers) ▶ watch danger balls

WICKETS — WHERE MOST COME FROM
Full wide outside off
60% of mapped wickets (15 of 25)

RUNS — WHERE MOST CONCEDED
Full wide outside off
39% of runs (317 of 819)

DANGER LINE
4th stump
3 wkts / 88 balls · 2.7% adj (3.4% raw) · low sample

DANGER LENGTH
Good Length
8 wkts / 307 balls · 2.5% adj (2.6% raw)

MOST LETHAL ZONE (BY RATE)
Full / Wide of 6th
15 wkts / 454 balls · 3.1% adj (3.3% raw)

Most threatening pitching a good length in the 4th-stump channel (8 wkts, 2.5% strike). Most wickets come from full wide outside off, while he leaks the most runs full wide outside off.

*Zone shares are over his **mapped** wickets — 3 wickets pitched too full to place on the map (tracked length at/behind the crease), so they sit outside the grid.*

Danger by ball age

NEW BALL (≤30 OV)

good length Wide of 6th

most lethal cell · 2.6 wkts/100 · danger length good length · 15 wkts off 635 balls

OLD BALL (31+ OV)

full Wide of 6th

most lethal cell · 3.6 wkts/100 · danger length full · 13 wkts off 771 balls

Match-ups (vs left-handers)

New ball vs old ball

Split	Balls	Wkts	Avg	Econ	SR	False%	Med length
New ball (≤30 ov)	635	15	29.5	4.18	42.3	14%	4.52 m
Old ball (31+ ov)	771	13	39.8	4.03	59.3	12%	4.34 m

By batting position

Split	Balls	Wkts	Avg	Econ	SR	False%	Med length
Top order (1–3)	562	12	32.9	4.22	46.8	13%	4.46 m
Middle (4–7)	612	8	55.9	4.38	76.5	13%	4.43 m
Tail (8–11)	232	8	14.8	3.05	29.0	14%	4.23 m

More yorkers/full at the tail (39%).

Lower average / higher false-shot = the match-up that suits him; higher average = where batters have got on top. Med length = his median pitch length in that split.

Scoring Profile (vs left-handers)

53% of his runs come in boundaries — a boundary every 12 balls; most runs go to the leg side (37%); the drive hurts most (35 fours/sixes at 2.5 runs/ball).

BOUNDARY %
53%
runs in 4s/6s

ROTATED %
47%
runs in 1s & 2s

BALLS / BOUNDARY
12

OFF SIDE %
35%
of runs

LEG SIDE %
37%
of runs

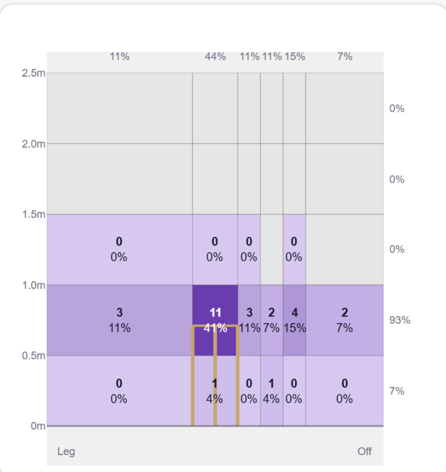
STRAIGHT %
29%
down the ground

Shot type	Balls	Runs	% runs	4s/6s	Runs/ball
Drive	87	214	30%	35	2.46
Sweep	74	165	23%	25	2.23
Work/Nudge	105	126	18%	4	1.20
Slog	23	89	13%	15	3.87
Cut	32	75	11%	12	2.34
Pull/Hook	16	37	5%	6	2.31

Direction from ball-tracking (all scoring shots); shot type recorded on 72% of scoring balls (355/493) — groups with <5 balls omitted.

Pitch Maps & Scoring

At the Stumps (wickets)

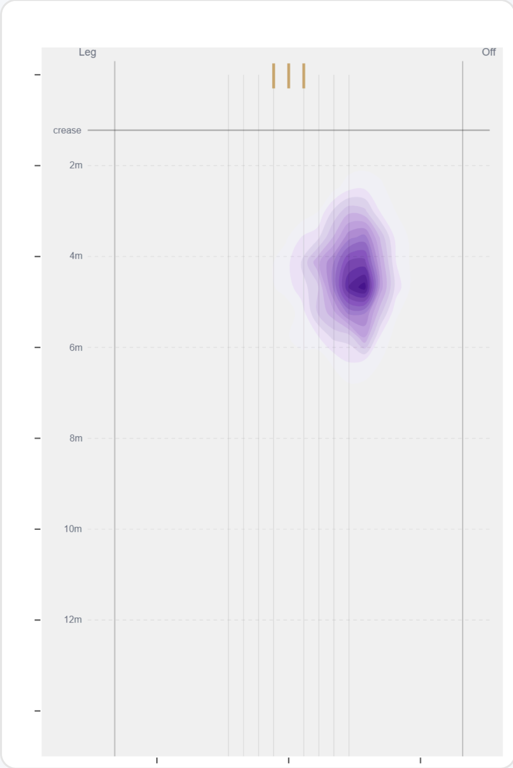


Wicket balls pass the stumps mostly at stumps — pitches around wide of 6th and moves it back.

Where They're Scored Off

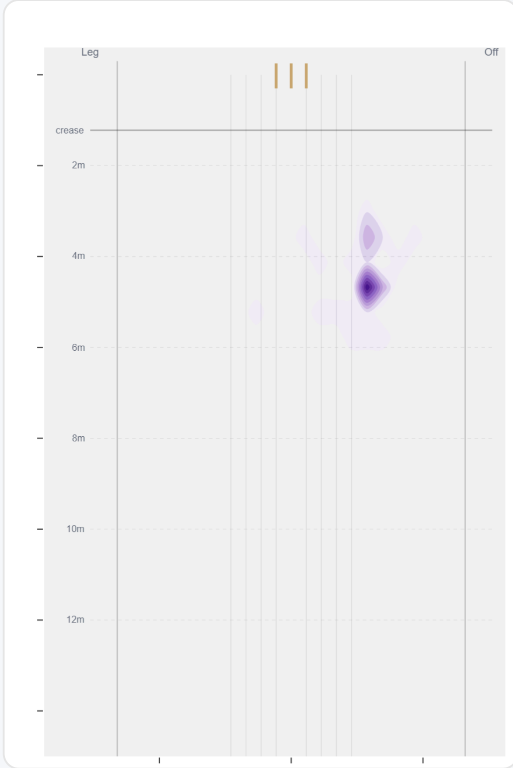
Runs come mostly on the off side (58%).

Where They Pitch It



Pitches it full wide outside off most often (38%); rarely drops short (0%).

Where Wickets Come From

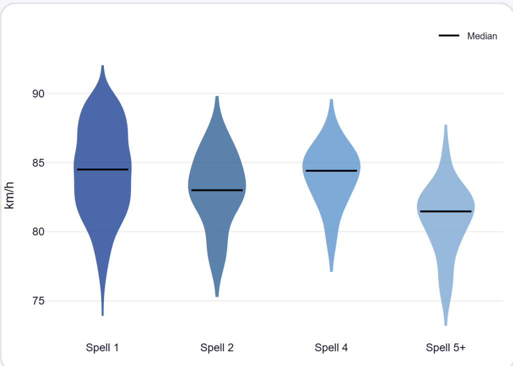


Wickets come mostly from balls pitched full wide outside off, but strikes most often pitching in the 4th-stump channel.

Speed & Spells

He holds his pace across spells, keeps his pace into the 2nd innings, and is as quick on the final day as day one.

Speed by Spell

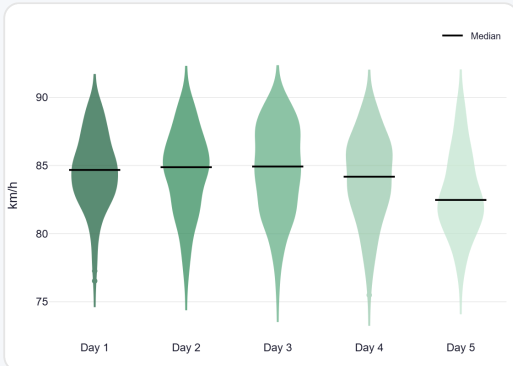


By spell — opening burst vs later spells.

Speed by Innings

1st vs 2nd innings of the match.

Speed by Day



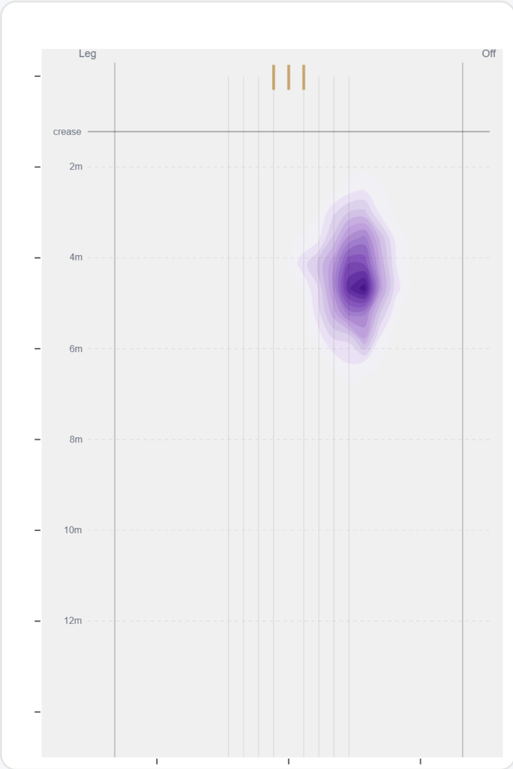
By match day — fatigue across the game.

Over vs Round the Wicket (vs left-handers)

Almost exclusively over the wicket to left-handers (89%, 1,257 balls); round the wicket is a rare change-up (11%, 149 balls).

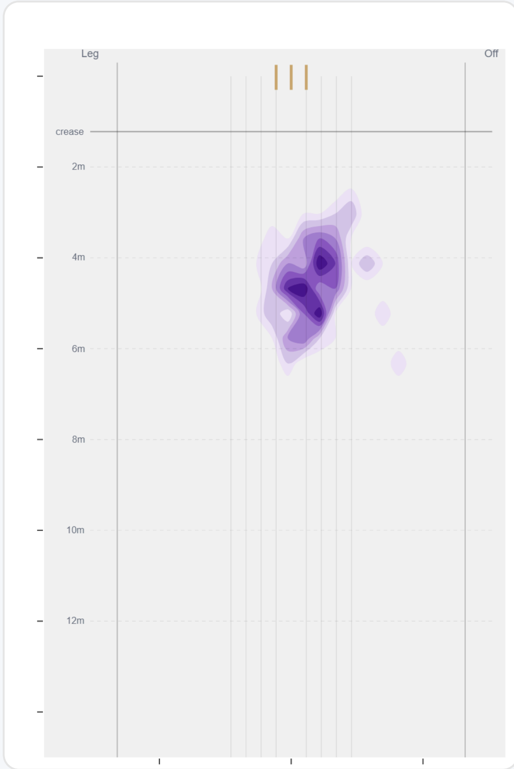
Angle	Balls	Pitch line	Length	Short %	Econ	Wkts	Bdry %
Over	1257 (89%)	Wide of 6th	4.4 m	0%	4.07	27	52%
Round	149 (11%)	Stumps	4.6 m	0%	4.35	1	65%

Over the Wicket



Where he pitches it from over the wicket (1257 balls).

Round the Wicket



Where he pitches it from round the wicket (149 balls).

Sequencing & Over Construction

Relentlessly consistent — repeats his length ball after ball (length spread ±1.0 m; more repeatable than 83% of spin bowlers); holds a steady length right through the over; and holds the same crease position through the over.

Takes his wickets with the stock ball rather than obvious set-ups.

Across 58 dismissals, his wicket ball is close in length and pace to the delivery before it — he builds pressure with repetition, not a big change-up.

Ball in over	Median length	Short %	Econ	Wkt %
Ball 1	4.3 m	0%	4.38	1.9%
Ball 2	4.4 m	0%	3.56	0.8%
Ball 3	4.5 m	0%	4.30	1.6%
Ball 4	4.4 m	0%	4.30	2.7%
Ball 5	4.4 m	0%	3.95	1.9%
Ball 6	4.5 m	0%	4.06	3.4%

Length spread = std-dev of pitch length (smaller = more repeatable). The table shows how his length, scoring and wicket rate shift across the six balls of an over. Set-up lines compare each ball with the previous delivery in the same over (career, all batters).

Release Point & Crease Use

A mid-height release point; releases about 81 cm from the middle stump. Comes wider round the wicket (47 cm over vs 81 cm round).

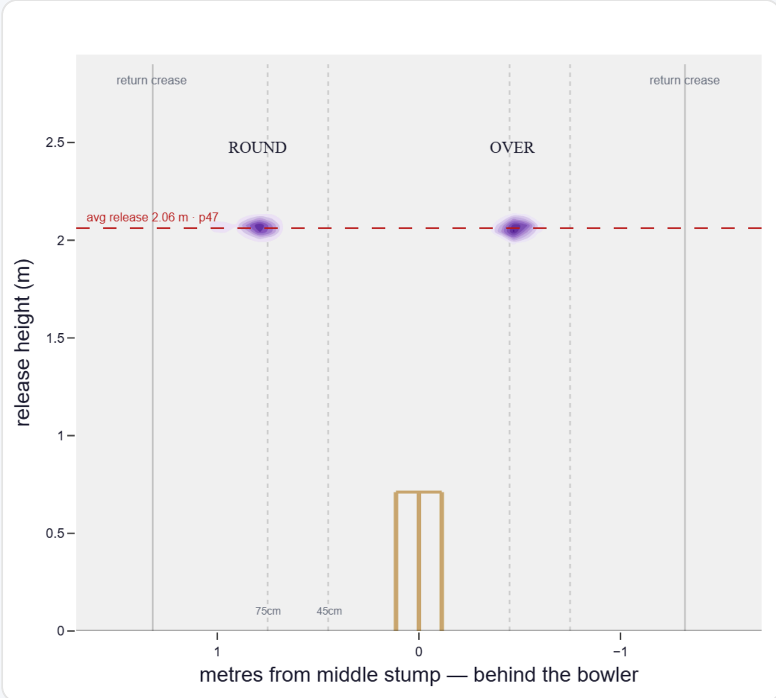
Crease position	% balls	Balls	Econ	Wkts	Avg	SR
Tight (<45cm)	7%	336	3.59	5	40.2	67
Standard (45–75)	38%	1,713	3.50	30	33.3	57
Wide (>75cm)	55%	2,519	2.78	48	24.4	52

How he goes when he releases tight / standard / wide of the middle stump (all release-tracked balls).

Angle	Balls	Tight	Standard	Wide
Over the wicket	32%	23%	69%	8%
Round the wicket	68%	0%	23%	77%

His crease-position mix, split by over vs round. Release data is modern-era (2017+); percentiles vs same hand + type.

Release Point (behind the bowler)



Where he lets the ball go — lateral position × height (purple density). Over and round labelled; dotted lines mark tight/standard/wide and the return creases.

Movement (vs the average spin bowler · vs left-handers)

A big turner of the ball; gets sharp drift in the air.

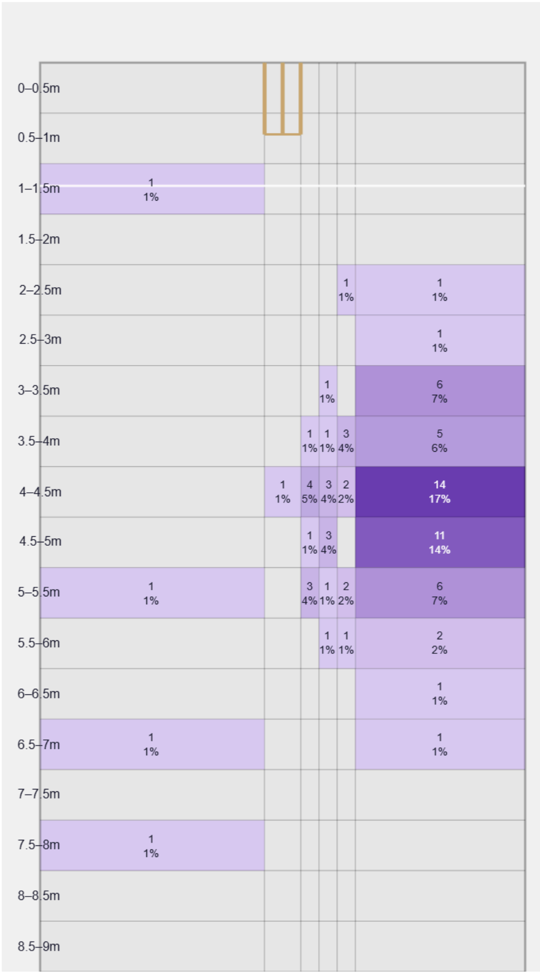
Generates well above avg turn and well above avg drift for a spin bowler; turns it in more to left-hand batters (99%).

Percentile vs all Test spin bowlers; direction is which way it moves to this batter. Bounce = extra bounce vs expected.

Movement	Avg	vs average	Direction (vs left-handers)
Drift	2.19°	89th pct (well above avg)	99% away / 1% in
Turn	4.68°	89th pct (well above avg)	0% away / 100% in
Bounce	4.3°	47th pct (about average)	—

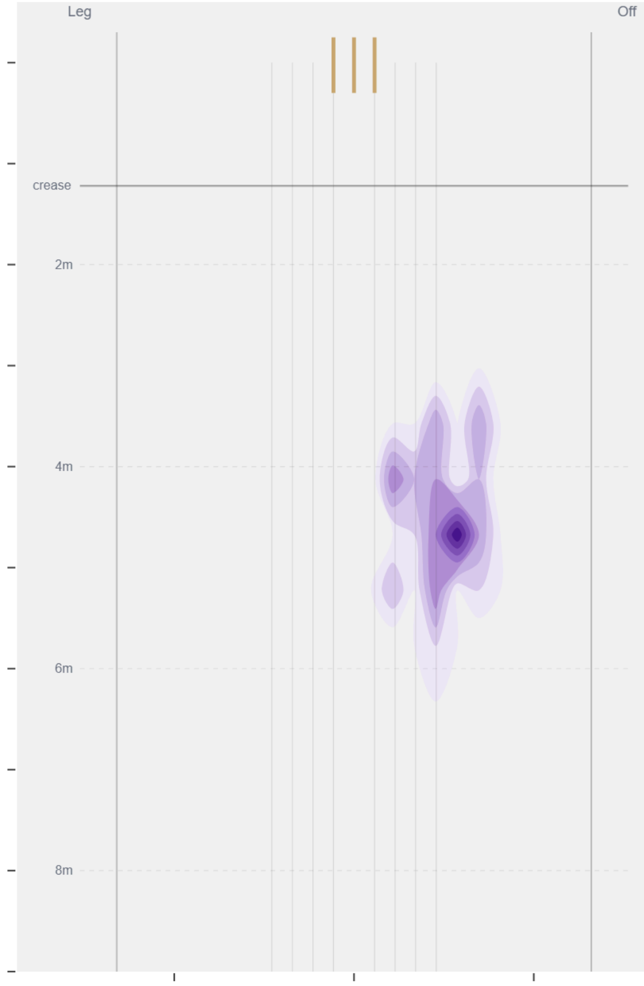
Beaten Zones (play-and-miss)

Beaten — Grid



Length × line where he beats the bat — exact counts per cell.

Beaten — Heatmap



The same play-and-miss density, smoothed, with pitch markings.

Beats the bat most at **Full / Wide of 6th** (46% of play-and-misses). Overall he beats the bat 6.0% of tracked balls (false-shot 13.1%, n=1,406).

Test-match career data. Beaten/false-shot use ~38% shot-quality tracking; turn/drift ~30% ball-tracking. Catches split by fielding position (DeliveryFielders view); some catches have no recorded position. Danger zones use empirical-Bayes shrinkage (≥3 wkts to qualify).